cropRaider

Grow crops, keep your harvest, watch the elephants.

Your goal

Finish with the most points

THE GAME

3 rounds × 10 turns. Every turn follows the same four steps.

1. **Look** — See your land: water, soil, crops, elephants.
2. **Act** — Spend up to 10 effort on the squares you choose.
3. **Confirm** — Lock in your choices.
4. **World moves** — Rain, growth, elephants, possible fines.

YOUR FOUR ACTIONS

You have 10 effort each turn. Every action costs effort.

Plant

Cost: 4 effort

Start a crop on an empty land square.

Gain: Crop grows on an S-curve: slow, fast, then levels off.

Water

Cost: 2 × distance to water

Water a crop. Not when it rains.

Gain: Full growth speed. Rain does the same. Dry and unwatered: only 45% of full speed.*

Harvest

Cost: 2 effort

Collect a crop and clear the square.

Gain: 3 points per unit of crop.

Defend

Cost: 5* effort

Protect a crop from elephants.

Gain: Elephants usually skip it (7 in 10).

What a square gives

Plants per square = 20 × soil quality. Thick grass means rich soil, so more plants fit.
Each full-grown plant adds up to 0.3 units. Best case: about 6 units = 18 points.

Protected land: a trade-off

Squares marked as protected have richer soil, so more plants fit there.
But a crop standing on protected land can be caught each turn:
chance of a fine → lose 2 points. Check the session's fine chance before you decide.

How elephants behave

Herds follow a lead female. Each turn she looks 3 squares around, finds the richest food (big crops, thick grass), usually skips defended squares, and heads for the one closest to water. Crops near water are most at risk.

KEEPING SCORE

Harvest a crop
+3 points per unit

Fined on protected land
–2 points

Elephants eat it
the crop is gone

Remember

- Planting costs 4 effort and harvesting 2, so each crop cycle costs 6 before any upkeep.
- Water costs more the farther the square is from water. Plant near water, or wait for rain.
- Defending costs more than most actions. Defend only crops worth the effort.

* Effort costs, the chance of a fine and the dry-growth rate can differ between sessions. Your facilitator will tell you.

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What changes from game to game

TWO THINGS CHANGE

1. **Chance of a fine**
   Each turn, a crop standing on protected land is caught with this chance, and you lose 2 points.
2. **Cost of defending**
   The effort it takes to defend one crop (out of your 10 effort per turn).

Everything else is the same in every game: 3 rounds of 10 turns, 10 effort per turn, planting 4, harvesting 2, 3 points per unit harvested, 2 points per fine. Rain, soil and elephants are random, so no two games play out alike.

THE GAMES

Enter the session ID to start the game you want.

Session ID	Game	Chance of a fine	Cost of defending
0	Practice	5% per turn	5 effort
1	Game 1	2% per turn	2 effort
2	Game 2	2% per turn	5 effort
3	Game 3	2% per turn	8 effort
4	Game 4	5% per turn	2 effort
5	Game 5	5% per turn	5 effort
6	Game 6	5% per turn	8 effort
7	Game 7	8% per turn	2 effort
8	Game 8	8% per turn	5 effort
9	Game 9	8% per turn	8 effort

Practice game: 1 round of 4 turns, with rain in turns 1 and 2 and none in turns 3 and 4. It does not count.
Compare how the same land plays when fines are rare or common, and when defending is cheap or costly.